

CLOSER TO THE FATHER

7 Days to a Closer Walk With the Father

A Simple Prayer Guide for Real Life

Seven minutes a day. One step closer to Him.



WELCOME

You are not behind

You picked this up because something in you wants more of God than you have right now. Maybe you have prayed your whole life and it has gone flat. Maybe you have never prayed and you are not sure you are allowed to. Either way, you are in the right place, and you are not behind.

This guide gives you seven days of prayer, seven minutes each. Every day has one verse, one short teaching, one guided prayer you can read out loud or in your head, and one action to take before the day ends. That is it. No study questions that take an hour. No theology exam. Just a daily meeting with the Father who has been waiting for you.

Here is the win. By day seven you will have a simple prayer habit you can keep, you will know how to talk to God in your own words, and you will feel the difference between knowing about Him and walking with Him.

So take it slowly. One day at a time. Do not skip ahead and do not beat yourself up if you miss a day. Come on, let's build this together.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Pick a time. Morning works best because the day has not touched you yet. Pick a place. A chair, a porch, the truck before you start it. Put your phone face down. Read the day. Pray the prayer. Do the action. Seven minutes.

THE PATH

Day 1 He Is Already Near

Day 2 Put Down What You Are Carrying

Day 3 He Already Knows

Day 4 The Door Is Jesus

Day 5 Listen

Day 6 Pray for Someone Else

Day 7 New Every Morning

Scripture quotations taken from The Holy Bible, New International Version® NIV®.
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DAY 1 OF 7

He Is Already Near

"Come near to God and He will come near to you."

James 4:8

Most people think God is far away and they have to earn the distance back. That is backwards. God is not standing across the room with His arms crossed. He is the Father in the story Jesus told, the one who saw his son coming from a long way off and ran to him. You take one step. He takes the rest.

So what does this imply? It means prayer is not a performance you have to get right. It is a door that is already open. Today you are not trying to reach God. You are noticing that He is here.

Take a moment to think. When was the last time you talked to God like He was actually in the room? Not a memorized line. A real conversation. If it has been a while, today is the day it starts again.

PRAY

Father, I am here. I do not have polished words and I am not sure I am doing this right, but You said if I come near, You will come near. So I am coming. Thank You for not making me earn my way back. Thank You for running toward me. Teach me to notice You today. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

Say one sentence to God out loud sometime today when no one is around. In the car, in the shower, on a walk. Just talk to Him like He is there. Because He is.

DAY 2 OF 7

Put Down What You Are Carrying

"Cast all your anxiety on Him because He cares for you."

1 Peter 5:7

Imagine walking into the house at the end of a long day with grocery bags cutting into both hands, and someone says, "Here, let me take those." You do not argue. You hand them over. That is what this verse is. God is not asking you to manage your worry better. He is asking you to hand it to Him.

Simply put, you were never built to carry it all. The pressure at work, the bill you do not know how to pay, the person you cannot fix, the fear you have not said out loud. Jesus said, "Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." That is not a slogan. It is an offer.

PRAY

Father, I have been carrying things You never asked me to carry. I hand them to You now. (Name them. Say them out loud.) I give You my worry about this. I give You my fear about that. I am tired, and You said You would give me rest. I am taking You at Your word. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

Write down the three things weighing on you most. Read them to God. Then draw a line through each one and write "His" next to it. Keep the paper. You will want it on day seven.

KEEP GOING

Handing it over does not mean it disappears by lunch. It means you stop being the one holding it alone. When it comes back to your mind today, and it will, say, "That one is His." Then keep going.

DAY 3 OF 7

He Already Knows

"Before a word is on my tongue, You, Lord, know it completely."

Psalm 139:4

A lot of people avoid prayer because they think they have to clean up before they show up. Get the attitude right. Fix the habit. Then come. No. God already knows the thing you are hiding. He knew it before you did it. And He is still here.

This is where prayer gets honest. You do not have to protect God from the truth about you. David, the man who wrote this psalm, was a king and a failure and a murderer and a worshiper, and he still called himself a man after God's own heart. Why? Because he never stopped bringing the real version of himself to God.

So today, drop the filter. Tell Him what you actually think. Tell Him where you are angry, where you doubt, where you messed up. He can handle it. He has been waiting for you to be this honest.

PRAY

Father, You already know. So I am going to stop pretending. Here is what I have actually been thinking. (Be honest. Say it.) Here is where I have failed. Here is where I am angry. I am not hiding anymore. Thank You that You knew all of it and stayed. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

Tell God one thing today you have never said to Him out loud. Just one. Notice that the sky does not fall. Notice that He is still there.

DAY 4 OF 7

The Door Is Jesus

"Jesus answered, 'I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.'"

John 14:6

Three days in, you have been talking to the Father. Today you need to know how that is even possible. The honest answer is that none of us earned the right to walk in. Our failures, the ones you named yesterday, put a wall between us and a holy God. Jesus tore that wall down. He lived the life we could not live, died the death we deserved, and rose again so the door would stay open.

So what does this imply? It means when you pray, you are not a stranger knocking. You are a son or a daughter walking in through a door that was paid for. Every prayer you pray goes through Jesus, and because of Him, the Father hears every word.

If you have never actually trusted Jesus with your life, today is not too soon. It is not complicated. You admit you need Him. You believe He died and rose for you. You ask Him to be your Savior and your Lord. That is the beginning of everything.

PRAY

Jesus, I need You. I cannot earn my way to the Father and I am done trying. I believe You died for me and rose again. Forgive me. Come into my life. Be my Savior and be my Lord. Father, thank You for sending Him. Thank You that the door is open and I am walking through it. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

If you prayed that and meant it for the first time, tell one person today. A text is enough. Saying it out loud makes it real. If you have walked with Jesus for years, thank Him today for the door. Out loud. Specifically.

IF TODAY WAS YOUR FIRST TIME

If you trusted Jesus for the first time today, this is the beginning of your walk with Him. Keep taking one step at a time. Visit Closer to the Father on YouTube for guided prayers and encouragement as you build a daily prayer habit.

Continue your journey: Closer to the Father on YouTube

DAY 5 OF 7

Listen

"My sheep listen to my voice; I know them, and they follow me."

John 10:27

Prayer is not a monologue. Most of us treat it like a voicemail. We leave the message and hang up. But Jesus said His sheep listen. That means God speaks, and you can learn to hear Him.

How? Mostly through His Word. The Bible is not a rulebook. It is the clearest way God talks. When you read it slowly and ask Him to speak, He does. Sometimes a verse lands like it was written for you this morning. That is not a coincidence. That is Him.

He also speaks in the quiet. The nudge to call someone. The peace that shows up when it should not. The conviction that will not leave. You will not hear a voice from the ceiling. You will notice that He is closer than you thought.

PRAY

Father, I have done most of the talking this week. Today I want to listen. Speak to me. Through Your Word, through Your Spirit, through the quiet. Give me ears to hear You and the courage to do what You say. I am not hanging up. I am staying here. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

Read Psalm 23 slowly. Then sit for two full minutes with no phone, no music, no talking. Ask, "Father, what do You want me to know today?" Write down the first thing that comes. Do not judge it. Just write it.

DAY 6 OF 7

Pray for Someone Else

"Carry each other's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

Galatians 6:2

Something changes in you when you stop praying only about yourself. Five days in, you know how to bring your own needs to God. Today you carry someone else's.

No man is an island. Every person you will see today is fighting something you cannot see. The coworker who is short with you. The family member you have written off. The friend who stopped calling. When you pray for them, two things happen. God moves on their behalf, and your heart softens toward them. You cannot stay bitter at someone you are honestly praying for. Try it.

PRAY

Father, today I bring You someone else. (Name them.) You know what they are carrying. I ask You to meet them there. Give them peace where they are anxious. Give them provision where they are short. Give them You where they are empty. And soften my heart toward them, especially if it has been hard. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

Pick one person. Pray for them by name. Then send them a message that says, "I prayed for you today." No explanation needed. Watch what it does.

PRAY FOR SOMEONE YOU HAVE NEVER MET

The Closer to the Father prayer wall has real requests from real people waiting for someone to pray. Go pray over one today. Then post your own.

Visit the prayer wall: www.closertothefather.com/prayer-wall

DAY 7 OF 7

New Every Morning

"His compassions never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness."

Lamentations 3:22-23

Seven days. Take a moment to think about where you were on day one. Maybe you were not sure God was listening. Maybe you had not prayed in years. Maybe you had never prayed at all. Now you have talked to Him honestly, handed Him what you were carrying, walked through the door Jesus opened, listened for His voice, and carried someone else to Him.

Do you remember how many times you thought you had blown it this week? Missed a day. Rushed a prayer. Forgot the action step. Here is the point of today's verse. His mercy is not a one-time deposit. It is new every morning. You do not run out. You do not get cut off. Every sunrise is a fresh start, and that is not a feeling. It is a promise.

Pull out the paper from day two. Look at the three things you crossed out. Some of them may still be there. That is fine. You are not carrying them alone anymore, and tomorrow's mercy is already on its way.

PRAY

Father, thank You for seven days with You. Thank You for meeting me when I did not know how to start. I am not going to stop here. Tomorrow morning, I will be back. And the morning after that. Not because I have to, but because You are here, and I want to be where You are. Great is Your faithfulness. In Jesus' name, amen.

TODAY'S ACTION

Decide right now, in writing, what time you will meet with God tomorrow. Put it on your calendar with an alarm. The habit is built. Now keep it.

AFTER DAY SEVEN

So, what's next?

You have the habit. Here is how to keep it alive.

Every morning, seven minutes. Verse, prayer, action. If you want it guided, the Closer to the Father YouTube channel has a morning prayer and a night prayer waiting for you every day. Press play and pray along.

Every week, pray for someone else. Use the prayer wall at the website. Post your own request. Pray over three others. When God answers, come back and give thanks so someone else can see what He did.

Every season, go deeper. Read one Gospel start to finish. Start with John. One chapter a day. It is the story of Jesus told by someone who walked beside Him.

LET'S QUICKLY RECAP

Day 1, you came near. Day 2, you put it down. Day 3, you got honest. Day 4, you walked through the door. Day 5, you listened. Day 6, you carried someone else. Day 7, you started again. That is not a program. That is a life with God.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Do not let day seven be the end.

Subscribe to Closer to the Father on YouTube and turn on notifications so a guided morning prayer is waiting for you every day. Then go to the prayer wall, post the one thing you are still carrying, and pray for one person while you are there.

WATCH AND PRAY ON YOUTUBE

<https://www.youtube.com/channel/UC5INMtGtvbf34D7gkYbbmBQ>

Seven minutes a day. One step closer to Him.
See you tomorrow morning.